a reminder that I was in a Communist country; *perestroika* or not, some things hadn't changed.

But perhaps the deepest impression I had during this experience and other meetings with Soviet citizens was that they were generally indistinguishable from people I had seen all my life on countless streets in America. They were simply ordinary people who longed, I am sure, for the same things that Americans did: peace, love, security, a better life for themselves and their children. On the streets of Moscow, looking into thousands of faces, I was reminded once again that it's not people who make war, but governments—and people deserve governments that fight for peace in the nuclear age.

The following day, during another meeting with Gorbachev, we agreed that we had both begun our relationship with misconceptions about the other, and that it had taken these one-on-one sessions to build trust and understanding. That, I thought to myself, was what I'd been trying to do since I sent my first letter to Brezhnev in 1981 a few weeks after I was shot.

That evening, the Gorbachevs invited us to dinner at their home in the wooded countryside outside Moscow. For a description of that evening, I'll rely on a memo written to me by Secretary Shultz:

> Memorandum for: The President
>
> From: George P. Shultz
>
> While the memory is still fresh, I want to record for you my thoughts on the remarkable evening you, Nancy, O'Bie, and I had with the Gorbachevs and Shevardnadzes. The dinner at the Tsarist palace they styled a dacha was an historic occasion between our two countries and deserves to be recorded for posterity.